



Going global

Skeletal and genetic evidence suggests that modern humans originated in Africa and spread across the globe from there, as reflected on this map. This is called the "Out of Africa" theory. An alternative "multiregional" theory suggests that *Homo sapiens* evolved simultaneously in many different parts of the world, from ancestors who had left Africa much earlier.

Changing environments

The ancient ancestors of modern humans evolved in the African tropics. Over time, as human species evolved larger brains and developed more advanced skills and behavior, they became better equipped to deal with the challenges of new environments.